

Contributing to Fly GACA

SECTION 01-governance

TYPE document

STATUS **active**

OWNER Founder

UPDATED 2026-08-05

Vendored copy — this is the application repo's (`FLyGACA/flygaca`) contributing guide, kept here for reference. Setup steps and paths refer to that repo's layout, not to this documents repo.

Thanks for your interest in improving Fly GACA — an independent, educational platform and open regulatory library for Saudi civil aviation. This guide covers how to get set up, the conventions that are load-bearing here, and the checks every change must pass.

Start with `CLAUDE.md` — it is the source of truth for the architecture and the project conventions. This file is the short operational companion to it.

Getting set up

```
npm install
# the site is a no-build static PWA — just serve it over HTTP:
python3 -m http.server 8000      # then open http://localhost:8000/flygaca.html
```

Pages fetch JSON from `assets/data/` at runtime, so they must be served over HTTP — opening a file directly (`file://`) will not work. To exercise Captain Adel locally, use the Firebase emulator (`firebase emulators:start`).

Conventions that are load-bearing

These are not style preferences — breaking them breaks the product:

- **Not affiliated with GACA.** Every user-facing surface reinforces one rule: verify against the latest official GACA publication. The product helps you find and study regulation, it never replaces it. Never imply official GACA status, and never fabricate a regulatory citation.
- **Bilingual + RTL.** English/العربية is a first-class requirement. New user-facing copy needs **both** an `data-en` and a matching `data-ar` (enforced by `npm run check:i18n`).
- **Never hand-edit the shared chrome.** The `<header class="site-nav">` and `<footer class="site-footer">` blocks are generated. Edit `partials/header.html` / `partials/footer.html` , then run `npm run build:chrome` . CI fails if pages drift.
- **Entitlements are server-only.** Clients may never write the `entitlement` field; paid access is granted exclusively by Cloud Functions via the Admin SDK. Don't add client-side bypasses.
- **Service worker freshness.** If you change cached assets, bump the version in `sw.js` .

- **Security headers / CSP** live in `firebase.json`. New external origins must be added there explicitly.

Before you open a PR

In this documents repo, the real pre-PR gate is `node tools/print/check.mjs`. It validates that every content `.md` carries the standard front-matter and has an up-to-date PDF under `_print/` (regenerate with `cd tools/print && npm run build`). The `npm run check:*` commands below are the **application** repo's — they are not runnable here and are kept only as part of this vendored reference. See the root `CLAUDE.md` for this repo's actual conventions.

Run the checks CI will run. Each exits non-zero on a violation:

```
npm run check:data      # library index counts + the README headline figures
npm run check:i18n      # bilingual parity (every data-en has a data-ar)
npm run check:links     # internal links, firebase routes, sw precache, sitemap
npm run check:chrome    # shared header/footer in sync across all pages
npm run test:unit       # fast node --test units (no external deps)
npm test                # Playwright E2E (smoke-loads every page + key flows)
```

If you touched library content, update the counts in `scripts/check-data.js` **and** the table in `README.md` together — the guard exists to keep them in sync.

Optional code style (not yet enforced in CI):

```
npm run format:check    # Prettier, scoped to source
npm run format          # auto-fix
```

An `.editorconfig` is provided; please keep files LF-terminated, UTF-8, with a final newline.

Pull requests

- Keep changes focused; describe what and why. Fill out the [pull request template](#).
- All CI checks must be green.
- By contributing, you agree your contributions are licensed under the [Apache License 2.0](#). Note that the regulatory **content** in this repo belongs to GACA and is not covered by that license (see `NOTICE`).

Reporting issues

Use the issue templates under `.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE/`. For anything that could be a security or data-isolation concern, please do **not** open a public issue — email the maintainer at ay2m@hotmail.com instead.